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Project #59: Framework for building a departmental quality and safety program

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Abstract

Introduction: The Department of Emergency Medicine (DEM) quality assurance and peer review program was established in 2015 and has been successful in formalizing the quality assurance. A gap existed in the translation of identification of gaps to translation to quality improvement and process improvement projects.

Quality management systems document processes, procedures, responsibilities for achieving quality policies and objectives. They're designed with a purpose to enhance the quality of care delivered to patients.

Methods: Beginning in January 2023, the DEM operations team performed a needs assessment and analysis of current state and accounting for growth opportunities in a future state regarding development of a quality management system. Key needs included incorporating the pillars of quality assurance, quality improvement and quality control while creating a culture of safety. The goal was to design a framework to address the inter-relationship of quality assurance, quality improvement and patient safety whilst maintain robust quality control.

Results: Development of a framework for quality management. To achieve the 3 identified pillars a new committee was formed: Quality Improvement and Patient Safety (Qu.I.P.S) Committee to complement and drive the quality improvement and patient safety efforts in the DEM

Conclusions: The development of a departmental quality management effort addressing quality assurance, quality improvement and patient safety is feasible. Other departments across the hospital may use this framework to develop local structures.

Components of a quality management system



Framework of key pillars



Roadmap to Qu.I.P.S

- Define the purpose
- Identify key stakeholders
- Define the scope
- Describe the organizational structure
- Define roles and responsibilities of committee leaders and members



Qu.I.P.S is about bringing together the QI initiatives in the DEM, creating awareness internally and externally, and providing guidance and support to ensure teams find success

It is **important** because improving processes and enhancing the quality of care delivered to our patients while improving the functionality of our teams will enhance value to the care we deliver

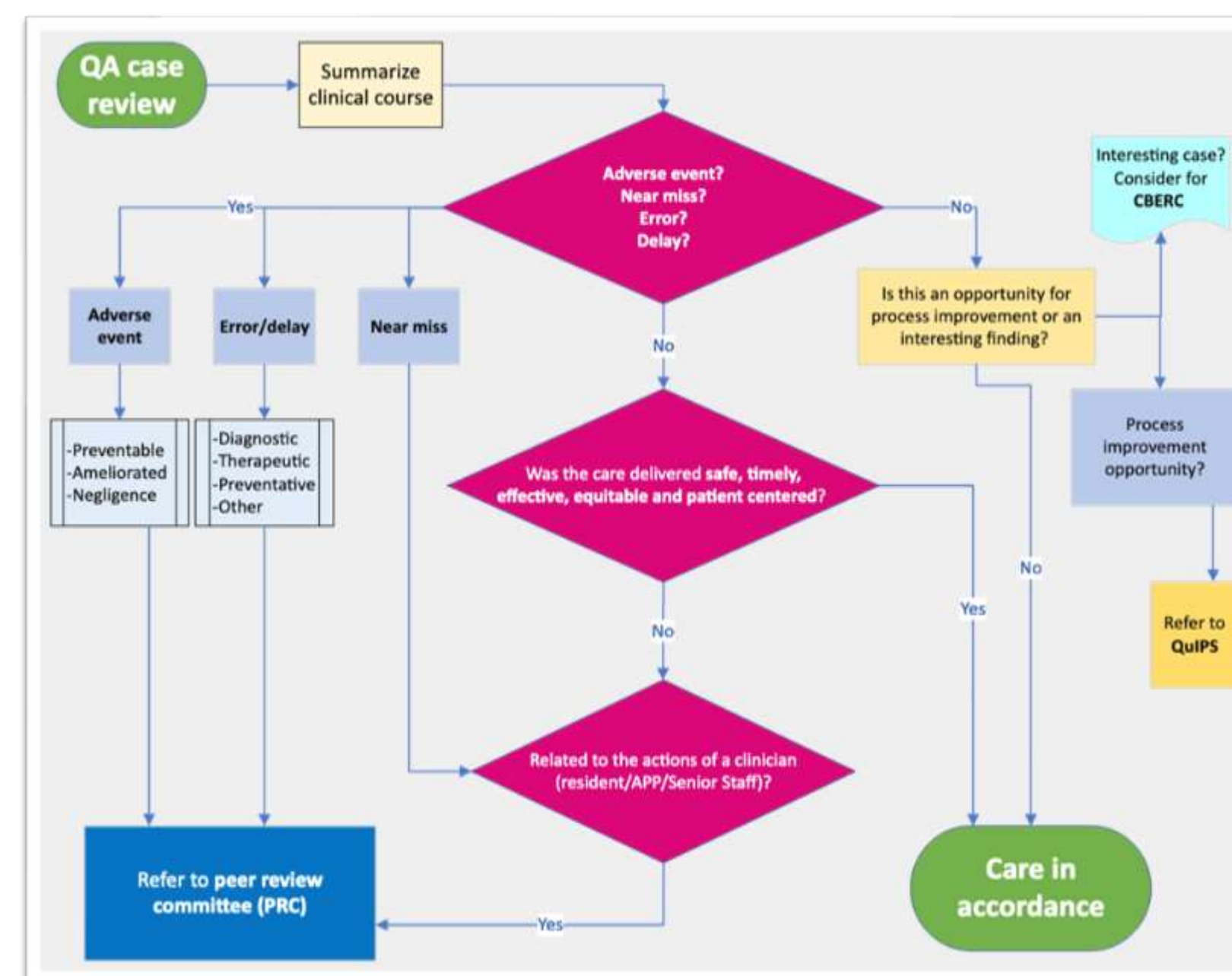
Success will look like an energized team, eager to design and implement quality improvement projects that are sustainable and enhance the patient and staff experience

What we need from you is enthusiasm, an open mind for collaboration, learning and participation

Jump in, share your ideas, let QuIPS know what's actively happening in the department and allow us to facilitate your success

Quality Assurance

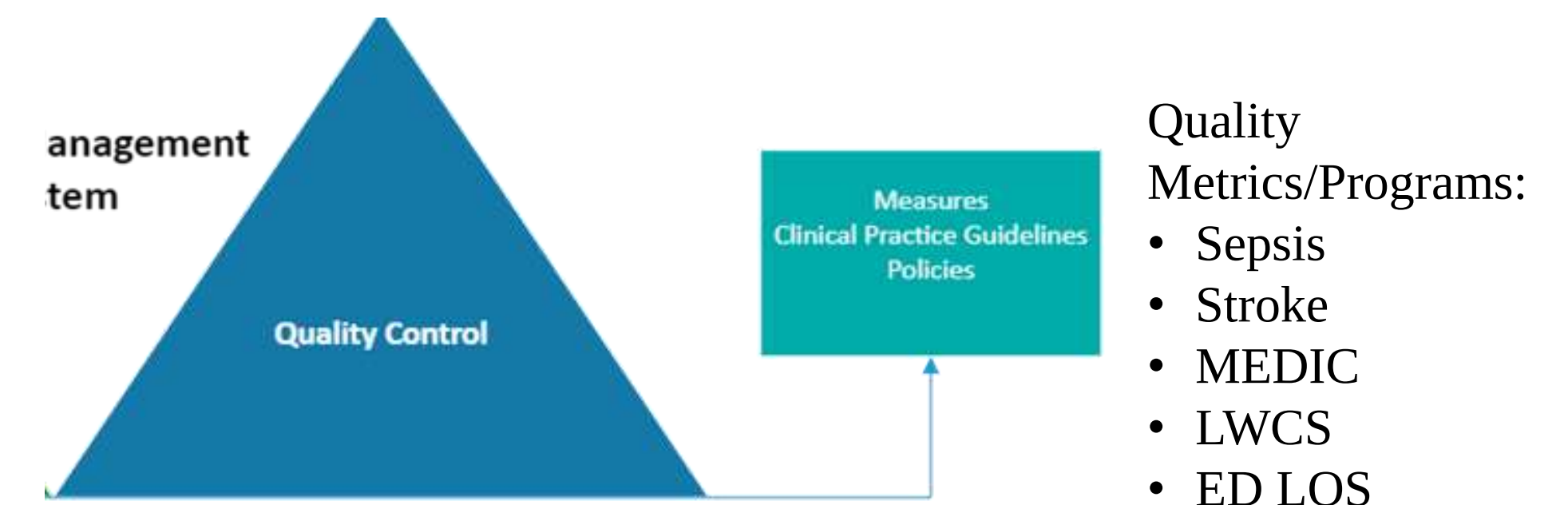
- Quality Assurance committee is charged with monitoring the safety and quality of care delivered while identifying:
 - Interesting/informative cases where there is gained value by informing the clinical team of the outcome of the case → discuss at Case Based Error Reduction Conference (CBERC)
 - Opportunities for process improvement → refer to QuIPS committee
 - Adverse events
 - Near miss events
 - Error(s)/delay(s)
 - Deviations from care rooted in the principles of safe, timely, effective, efficient equitable and patient centered



Peer Review

- Aim: Conduct ongoing professional practice evaluation of an individual practitioner's care delivered by a group of peers. It's purpose is to ensure the continued safe practice by all clinicians (Senior Staff Physicians, Advanced Practice Providers) in our department as a protection to the public we serve

Quality control



Bibliography

- <https://asq.org/quality-resources/quality-management-system>
- Chartier LB, Masood S, Choi J, McGovern B, Casey S, Friedman SM, Porplycia D, Tosoni S, Sabbah S. A blueprint for building an emergency department quality improvement and patient safety committee. CJEM. 2022 Mar;24(2):195-205. doi: 10.1007/s43678-021-00252-2. Epub 2022 Feb 2. PMID: 35107806; PMCID: PMC8808466.